

Hospital Emergency Queue - Bubble Sort Using Arrays

1. Real-Time Scenario

CityCare Multi-Specialty Hospital receives hundreds of emergency patients every day. Each patient is assigned an Emergency Level from 1 to 5. Level 1 - Critical (Immediate Treatment) Level 2 - Serious Level 3 - Moderate Level 4 - Minor Level 5 - Stable Due to a system issue, patient records are stored in random order. Arrange the patients so doctors always treat the most critical patients first. Use only Pure Arrays and Bubble Sort.

2. Input

Patient ID	Name	Level
P101	Rahul	3
P102	Priya	1
P103	Amit	5
P104	Sneha	2
P105	Arjun	4

3. Visual Representation

Current Queue

■ Arrival
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	Rahul	Level 3	
	Priya	Level 1	
	Amit	Level 5	
	Sneha	Level 2	
	Arjun	Level 4	

Goal

	Priya	Level 1	
	Sneha	Level 2	
	Rahul	Level 3	
	Arjun	Level 4	
	Amit	Level 5	

4. Bubble Sort Dry Run

Initial

3 1 5 2 4

Pass 1

3 > 1 -> Swap

1 3 5 2 4

5 > 2 -> Swap

1 3 2 5 4

5 > 4 -> Swap

1 3 2 4 5

Pass 2

3 > 2 -> Swap

1 2 3 4 5

Queue Sorted

5. Pseudo Algorithm

START

Read PatientID[]

Read PatientName[]

Read EmergencyLevel[]

FOR each pass

 Compare adjacent levels

 IF left > right

 Swap EmergencyLevel

 Swap PatientID

 Swap PatientName

 END IF

Repeat until sorted

Display treatment queue

STOP

6. Key Idea

When two emergency levels are swapped, the corresponding Patient ID and Patient Name must also be swapped because they belong to the same patient record (parallel arrays).

7. Interview Tips

• Why use Bubble Sort? • Why are three arrays swapped together? • What happens if two patients have the same emergency level? • Time Complexity: $O(n^2)$ • Space Complexity: $O(1)$